

- Chose this passage because it provides good insight into the issues of societal collapse and wealth in response to disaster.
- For context, this passage is directly after an earthquake and several fires which Lauren is trying to escape the damages of by going North. This is how they encounter these bridges
- The way the police and the national guard are portrayed shows that society as we know it is basically completely dysfunctional.
 - Instead of protecting people, the police on the bridges are there to rob people like gangs, and the only thing Lauren sees coming from the National Guard is further chaos
 - Clear abuse of power from the police (can't really be punished), and the national guard doesn't hold enough power to do anything beneficial
 - These are two of the only direct government actions we've seen so far, and they are disasters.
- Also shows the extreme power of wealth, and what happens without it
 - The rich escape to safety easily and leave all of the challenges and dangers to the poor, who are described as desperate.
 - I think the wording here of being poor as a penalty is very telling, and it isn't a minor penalty. These people live with the constant danger of everything being taken from them, even their own life.
- I think this sort of lawless chaos is very similar to what we see in the areas affected by Hurricane Katrina in *Odds Against Tomorrow*
 - For example, New York City and Camp Ticonderoga are seen in Mitchell and Jane's journey to safety as lawless, chaotic places where people hurt and stole from one another for their own

survival. Any semblance of government assistance had been abused and completely destroyed, which only left violence.